Northwind Data Platform: Q4 2026 Infrastructure Cost Estimate

SAMPLE DOCUMENT. All company names and figures are fictional, made for testing Winbot.

1. Summary

This estimate covers the AWS infrastructure for the Northwind data team in Q4 2026. It includes production and staging environments across two regions: us-east-1 (primary) and ap-southeast-1 (secondary). The total estimated cost is $12,400 per month, or $37,200 for the quarter. The largest cost is Amazon RDS at $5,200 per month.

The estimate was prepared by the Platform team on 1 October 2026 and approved by the Head of Engineering. Questions should go to the #platform-help channel.

2. Assumptions

All prices use AWS on-demand rates as of September 2026. No Reserved Instances or Savings Plans are applied. Data transfer between regions is estimated at 2 TB per month. Staging runs 12 hours per day on weekdays only, which is about 36% of production hours.

Production runs 24/7. The RDS production database is a db.r6g.xlarge Multi-AZ instance in us-east-1. EC2 runs six m6i.large instances for the ingestion workers.

3. Monthly cost by service

Service	Production	Staging	Monthly total
EC2	$3,300	$800	$4,100
RDS	$4,600	$600	$5,200
S3	$1,150	$150	$1,300
Other (CloudWatch, data transfer, NAT)	$1,500	$300	$1,800
Total	$10,550	$1,850	$12,400

RDS is the most expensive service, mainly because of the Multi-AZ production database in us-east-1. S3 cost grows about 5% per month as raw data accumulates.

4. Savings opportunities

1. Buy a 1-year Reserved Instance for the RDS production database: saves about 30%, roughly $1,380 per month.

2. Apply a Compute Savings Plan to EC2: saves about 20%, roughly $660 per month.

3. Add an S3 lifecycle rule to move raw data older than 90 days to S3 Glacier Instant Retrieval: saves about $400 per month.

Taken together these could reduce the monthly total from $12,400 to about $9,960. Decisions on Reserved Instances need approval from Finance before 15 November 2026.